

IK 557: The Study of Dharma

Course Code	IK 557
Course Name	The Study of Dharma
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	None
Intended for	BTech/MTech/MS/MSc/MA/Ph.D
Mutual Exclusion	None
Approval	42nd Senate (Jan 2024)

Course Contents

- **Introduction to Dharma:** Defining Dharma; Historical and philosophical overview; Significance in the Indian context. (6 Hours)
- **Dharma in the Vedas and Upanishads:** Early Vedic conceptions of Dharma; Rituals and ethics in the Vedas; Philosophical expositions in the Upanishads. (7 Hours)
- **Dharma in the Epics:** Rāmāyaṇa and Mahabharata: Dharma in the choices of Rama and Krishna; Ethical dilemmas; The Bhagavad-Gītā's discourse on svadharma. (8 Hours)
- **Dharma in Dharmashastras and Legal Texts:** Manusmriti and other Dharmashastras; Varied roles and duties based on caste, age, and occupation; Evolution of social laws and customs. (7 Hours)
- **Dharma in Buddhism and Jainism:** Dharma as the teachings of Buddha; Eightfold Path; Jain principles of non-violence and asceticism. (7 Hours)
- **Dharma in Contemporary Times:** Modern interpretations and challenges; Dharma in politics, society, and individual life; Global relevance. (7 Hours)

Laboratory Modules

- NA

Text Books

1. Kane, P.V, **History of Dharmashastra: Ancient and Medieval Religious and Civil Law**, Bhandarkar Oriental Research Institute, 1968. <https://indianculture.gov.in/ebooks/history-dharmasastra-ancient-and-medieval-religious-and-civil-law-india>
2. Ganguli, K. M., **The Mahabharata of Krishna-Dwaipayana Vyasa**, Independently published, 2016. <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15474>

References

1. Radhakrishnan, S., & Moore, C. A., **A Sourcebook in Indian Philosophy**, Princeton University Press, 1992.
2. Olivelle, P., **DharmaSūtras: The Law Codes of Ancient India**, Oxford World's Classics, 1999.